INFINITY CRISIS
AVENGERS & JUSTICE LEAGUE VS. THANOS

Screenplay
Production Draft 1

Characters from Marvel Comics and DC Comics. Non-commercial fan production concept.

18 October 2026
Running time 12:12 at 24 fps. Scene numbers match the shot list (docs/C_storyboard).

SEQUENCE 1 — THE SKY BREAKS

FADE IN:

1.1 **EXT. LOW EARTH ORBIT - NIGHT** 1.1

Absolute silence.

Earth turns below us, the night side lit by the gold filigree of its cities. Thin clouds catch moonlight. The dawn line is a blade of blue at the planet's edge.

A communications satellite drifts through the foreground, solar panels flaring as they catch the hidden sun. It slides out of frame.

We push slowly toward the eastern seaboard of North America, where the lights pool thickest.

1.2 **EXT. UPPER ATMOSPHERE - CONTINUOUS** 1.2

We sink through a thin deck of cloud. Through the gaps: a coastline, a harbor, a city grid laid out in light. Wind, faint and far away. Somewhere beneath it, a low choir holds one note.

1.3 **EXT. NEW YORK CITY - SKYLINE - NIGHT** 1.3

Rain. Glass towers glow from within, ten thousand windows, ten thousand lives. The river carries their reflections in long trembling bars of light.

1.4 **EXT. MIDTOWN AVENUE - NIGHT** 1.4

Street level. Umbrellas. A delivery cyclist weaves between taxis. Headlights smear across wet asphalt. A couple shares a jacket over their heads, laughing. An ordinary night.

1.5 **EXT. MIDTOWN SKYLINE - NIGHT** 1.5

Locked off. Wide. The skyline against low cloud.

High above the tallest spire, a POINT OF PURPLE LIGHT appears. Tiny. Perfectly still.

A pedestrian in the foreground stops walking. Then another.

1.6 **EXT. MIDTOWN AVENUE - LOOKING UP - NIGHT** 1.6

From the bottom of the canyon of towers we tilt up, past rain, past the lit floors, to the sky.

The point of light OPENS, a ring of violet fire unfolding into a colossal circular RUPTURE in space. Geometric patterns etch outward across the clouds: concentric rings, then a lattice of hexagons, glowing like lines on a blueprint of the sky.

The clouds begin to turn, spiralling slowly toward the opening.

The city's light changes color. Sodium orange drains to violet.

A deep tone rises under everything. A CAR ALARM starts. Then a dozen.

1.7 **INSERT - GLASS CURTAIN WALL** 1.7

Raindrops on a window shiver in place. The glass HUMS. The purple ring is reflected in it, warped. A hairline crack races across the pane.

1.8 **EXT. MIDTOWN AVENUE - NIGHT** 1.8

A WOMAN (30s, rain-dark coat) looks up. Purple light fills her eyes.

Around her face the falling RAIN STOPS. Every drop hangs in the air, a curtain of glass beads.

She breathes out. Her breath does not move them.

Then the rain falls again.

1.9 **EXT. ROOFTOP CORNICE - NIGHT** 1.9

Pigeons explode off a stone ledge, a burst of wings against the violet sky.

1.10 **EXT. SKY OVER THE HARBOR - NIGHT** 1.10

An airliner, landing lights blazing, BANKS HARD away from the rupture, its wing dipping across the burning ring.

1.11 **INT. HUDSON RADIO OBSERVATORY - CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT** 1.11

DR. LENA OKAFOR (50s, astrophysicist) stands frozen before a wall of monitors. Every trace on every screen climbs

vertically off its scale. A seismograph pen scratches itself into a black scribble. She doesn't blink.

1.12 **EXT. MIDTOWN AVENUE - NIGHT** 1.12

Close on two hands: a CHILD's small hand inside a PARENT's.

The violet light sweeps across them.

The small fingers tighten.

1.13 **EXT. THE RUPTURE - NIGHT** 1.13

Something moves inside the ring.

Then the FLEET pours through: hundreds of angular black ships, running lights burning violet, spilling from the opening like sparks from a forge.

1.14 **EXT. NEW YORK HARBOR - EXTREME WIDE - NIGHT** 1.14

From across the water, the whole city is a strip of light at the bottom of the frame. Above it, the rupture fills the sky.

The fleet parts.

And the last ship emerges: THE SILENT THRONE, Thanos's flagship, a black cathedral the size of a mountain range, its prow alone wider than the island beneath it. The other ships are flecks of ash beside it.

Brass, low and terrible, enters for the first time.

1.15 **EXT. THE SILENT THRONE - OBSERVATION PROW - NIGHT** 1.15

Wind roars across an open platform at the ship's prow. At its edge stands THANOS: a Titan in gold-edged armor, purple-skinned, vast. We see him from behind, his silhouette blotting out half the city below.

THANOS
(quietly)
Every world believes it is the exception.

1.16 **CLOSE ON THANOS** 1.16

Profile. The violet light of the rupture traces the ridges of his jaw. We push in, slowly.

He lets the silence sit.

THANOS
Every world learns the truth.

1.17 **EXT. SKY OVER NEW YORK - NIGHT** 1.17

The fleet tips forward as one. Engines flare. They fall toward the city like a storm of burning stars.

1.18 **EXT. MIDTOWN - CONTINUOUS** 1.18

The first wave STRIKES.

A white flash. A shockwave ring tears across the skyline, blowing rain into mist.

SMASH CUT TO:

SEQUENCE 2 — THE AVENGERS RESPOND

2.1 **EXT. MIDTOWN AVENUE - NIGHT** 2.1

A thin high whine. Tinnitus.

Smoke rolls down the avenue. A traffic light swings on one cable. Debris patters down like hail. Sound floods back in: alarms, sirens, screaming.

2.2 **EXT. MIDTOWN SKYLINE - NIGHT** 2.2

A streak of red and gold: IRON MAN rockets between towers, repulsors flaring, banking so close to a glass face that his reflection races beside him.

2.3 **INT. IRON MAN HELMET - CONTINUOUS** 2.3

TONY STARK's face, lit blue by the HUD. Targets bloom across the display, one after another, until the counter reads 212.

TONY
Two hundred and twelve. Great. Love that.

2.4 **EXT. FIFTH AVENUE - NIGHT** 2.4

CAPTAIN AMERICA stands on the roof of an abandoned bus, waving first responders and civilians toward a subway

entrance. Explosions bloom across the face of his shield.

STEVE
Underground! Keep moving! Help each other!

2.5 **EXT. STORM CLOUDS - NIGHT** 2.5

The clouds above the river light from inside. THOR descends through the thunderhead, lightning crawling over his weathered armor. He raises STORMBREAKER.

A bolt the width of a building strikes an enemy CARRIER. It splits down the middle.

2.6 **EXT. EAST RIVER - NIGHT** 2.6

Low on the water. Both halves of the carrier slam into the river, well clear of the bridges. Twin columns of spray climb into the rain.

2.7 **EXT. MIDTOWN ROOFTOPS - NIGHT** 2.7

HULK vaults from a broken water tower to a rooftop to the street, each landing cratering stone. Below, a six-legged CRAWLER tank clanks toward a crowded intersection.

2.8 **EXT. INTERSECTION - NIGHT** 2.8

Hulk lands on the Crawler's back, digs his fingers under its armor and HEAVES it sideways off the avenue into an empty parking structure. The crowd streams past beneath him.

2.9 **EXT. BETWEEN SKYSCRAPERS - NIGHT** 2.9

SPIDER-MAN swings through a canyon of glass, web line taut to a cornice high above, body rotating through the bottom of the arc.

2.10 **EXT. SIXTH AVENUE - CONTINUOUS** 2.10

A section of shattered façade tears loose and falls toward a crowd. Spider-Man fires two lines, three, four, and catches it in a web net a story above their heads.

SPIDER-MAN
Got it, got it... okay, mostly got it.

2.11 **EXT. BRYANT PARK - NIGHT** 2.11

DOCTOR STRANGE hangs in the air, cloak rippling. A burning water tower plunges toward the park. He draws a ring of orange sparks and the tower falls INTO a portal, emerging harmlessly above the river.

A second portal opens across a blocked street. A crowd hurries through it, from danger into a safe plaza.

2.12 **EXT. BROOKLYN BRIDGE APPROACH - EVACUATION CORRIDOR - NIGHT** 2.12

A barricade of city buses. Civilians stream onto the bridge behind it. HOLLOWS, faceless armored soldiers, open fire.

BLACK PANTHER steps into the barrage. The blasts hit his suit and sink into it, lighting the vibranium weave purple. He drops to one knee, palms to the asphalt, and RELEASES it: a kinetic wave that sweeps the Hollows off their feet.

2.13 **EXT. FORTY-SECOND STREET - NIGHT** 2.13

Something is wrong with this block.

The rain is falling UP. A taxi drifts gently off the ground, wheels turning on nothing, then drops. Under the streetlights, every shadow points the wrong way, toward the light.

2.14 **EXT. MIDTOWN SKY - NIGHT** 2.14

Tracking with Iron Man as he blasts a dropship's engines and drives it, spinning, straight at Thor, who meets it with Stormbreaker. It comes apart in a shower of sparks.

Across the city the Hollows fall back.

2.15 **EXT. THE CROSSING - INTERSECTION - NIGHT** 2.15

A broad, ruined intersection. The Avengers converge: Thor lands, Iron Man touches down, Hulk drops from a rooftop, Spider-Man perches on a bent traffic signal, Strange floats down. Captain America walks into the center. Smoke drifts. The wave is broken.

For a moment the city is quiet. Only the rain.

SPIDER-MAN
Was that it? That felt like it.

TONY
It's never it.

2.16 **EXT. THE CROSSING - CONTINUOUS** 2.16

Every Hollow on the street STOPS. Mid-step. Mid-reload.

Then, as one, they KNEEL. A single metallic clank rolls down the avenue.

2.17 **EXT. MIDTOWN SKYLINE - NIGHT** 2.17

A SHADOW sweeps across the towers, swallowing window after window. Something enormous is moving between the city and the light.

2.18 **EXT. THE CROSSING - CONTINUOUS** 2.18

The Avengers look up. Steve. Tony. Thor tightens his grip on Stormbreaker.

High in the smoke, a vast silhouette is descending, wreathed in violet light.

Thanos has arrived.

SEQUENCE 3 — THE TITAN ENTERS THE WAR

3.1 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 3.1

Low and wide from the far end of the street. Thanos descends slowly through a column of smoke lit violet from within, debris turning lazily around him.

His FEET STRIKE THE GROUND.

The pavement cracks outward in a star.

A circular SHOCKWAVE races out through the dust: broken glass skitters, puddles leap, car windows burst in a ring.

We start low, at his boots, and TILT UP slowly: armored greaves, the gauntlet with its six burning STONES, the chest plate, the scarred jaw. Until Thanos fills the frame.

He studies the Avengers the way a man studies weather.

THANOS
This world is not my target.

(beat)
It is my anchor. The last one I need.

Thor's eyes flood with white light.

THOR
Then you will not have it.

Lightning BURSTS from the clouds into Stormbreaker. Thor launches across the intersection and brings the axe down with everything he has.

Thanos raises the gauntlet.

The strike lands on it. A violent BURST of white light; a ring of dust blasts out across the street, shoving cars aside.

When the smoke thins, Thanos is still standing. Thor is still pressing down with both hands, and Thanos takes a step forward, through the smoke, pushing him back.

From the left, CAPTAIN AMERICA charges, shield first. From above, IRON MAN dives, repulsors blazing. From the right, HULK launches himself across the street.

For four seconds, it works. Steve's shield cracks into the back of Thanos's knee and his weight shifts. A repulsor blast staggers him. Hulk's fist connects with his jaw and drives him a full stride back, boots gouging the asphalt.

3.2 **CLOSE ON THANOS** 3.2

His eyes move, once, to each attacker. Reading them.

He adapts.

Thor swings again. Thanos steps INSIDE the arc, guides the haft past his body and turns, hurling Thor by his own momentum into the side of a bus.

Iron Man fires. Thanos opens his hand, and the blast vanishes into a pinhole of blue light, then erupts from a second pinhole BEHIND Iron Man and slams him out of the air.

Hulk throws a haymaker. Thanos sways back a hand's width; the fist craters the pavement where he stood. Thanos drives an elbow down onto the back of Hulk's neck and buries him in his own crater.

Steve vaults in, shield raised. Thanos catches the shield's edge in his fist and holds it, and Steve with it, at arm's length.

The Stones FLARE purple.

An ENERGY PULSE erupts from the gauntlet, a ring of force that hurls Steve, Hulk and the debris of the street across the intersection.

The wave rolls toward the last defenders: SPIDER-MAN, crouched over an injured paramedic, and Strange.

DOCTOR STRANGE throws up his hands. An orange MANDALA blooms, layered rings of glowing geometry, and the wave breaks against it like surf.

Thanos looks directly at Strange through the burning shield.

THANOS
Magic. Technology. Strength.

He slowly closes his hand. Cracks race across the mandala.

THANOS (CONT'D)
Different names for the same illusion.

He gestures behind the Avengers. Space tears open, a rupture the height of the towers, and through it, impossibly far away, a colossal MACHINE turns in a starless void: rings within rings around a sphere of violet fire.

SPIDER-MAN
What is that?

STRANGE
(quietly)
Something that isn't in our universe.

3.3 **EXT. SKY OVER MIDTOWN - CONTINUOUS** 3.3

Before Thanos can step toward the opening, a SECOND TEAR splits the clouds above the city. This one burns blue-white, not violet.

Through it, a figure in red and blue descends through the cloud, accelerating, and a sonic boom rings out across the sky.

Superman.

SEQUENCE 4 — THE JUSTICE LEAGUE ARRIVES

4.1 **EXT. MERCY GENERAL HOSPITAL - NIGHT** 4.1

A crippled MONOLITH cruiser, a black slab the length of three city blocks, drops toward a hospital. On the roof, nurses push patients in beds toward a stairwell. A doctor looks up and stops.

SUPERMAN slams into the underside of the hull.

4.2 **CLOSE ON SUPERMAN** 4.2

His hands sink into the metal. The weight drives him DOWN. Teeth bared, cape snapping, his whole body shaking with effort. The hull groans.

4.3 **EXT. HOSPITAL ROOF - CONTINUOUS** 4.3

The cruiser's prow sinks toward the roof... ten meters... five...

It stops.

Superman ROARS and the ship begins, slowly, to rise.

4.4 **EXT. SKY OVER THE CITY - CONTINUOUS** 4.4

Tracking from behind Superman as he drives the cruiser up and over the city, the lit streets sliding away beneath him, the black hull filling the sky above. He angles it toward the dark, empty grid of an industrial zone by the water.

He lets go. The cruiser falls into the empty district and erupts in a distant fireball.

Superman turns in midair. Far below, in a ruined intersection, a Titan stands among fallen heroes.

4.5 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 4.5

Superman lands between Thanos and the injured Avengers. The ground dishes under his boots; a ring of dust rolls out. His cape settles slowly in the wind.

Thanos looks him over.

THANOS
Another champion.

SUPERMAN
If you're here to hurt this world,
you're going to have to go through

us.

Lightning lights the clouds from horizon to horizon.

WONDER WOMAN lands beside Superman, bracers clanging.

BATMAN emerges from the smoke, CYBORG a step behind him, scanning.

THE FLASH arrives in a streak of red lightning that crackles away into the rain.

Above the street, GREEN LANTERN spreads a glowing green dome; falling debris and fire from the circling fleet break across it.

AQUAMAN charges out of a flooded avenue in a sheet of spray, trident in hand.

Thanos regards them all. The faintest smile.

THANOS
Good. Bring them all.

He steps backward into his rupture. It seals behind him. Along the avenue, the kneeling Hollows rise and withdraw into the smoke.

4.6 **EXT. THE CROSSING - MOMENTS LATER** 4.6

Rain hisses on hot metal. Two lines of heroes face each other across the broken asphalt: Avengers on one side, the Justice League on the other. Nobody moves first.

Batman kneels by a fallen Hollow and passes a gauntlet scanner over its armor. His lenses fill with a jagged waveform.

Inside Tony's helmet, the HUD draws THE SAME WAVEFORM.

The two men look at each other. Neither likes what he sees.

TONY
Please tell me your universe has a manual for purple warlords.

BATMAN
No. We usually prepare for them before they arrive.

The Flash snorts. Wonder Woman shoots him a look; he straightens.

Strange spreads his hands. A mandala unfolds into layered panes of light, like sheets of glass stacked into the distance. Every pane is cracking along the same line.

STRANGE
The fracture isn't just here. It runs through every layer of reality I can see. Ours. Theirs. All of them.

CYBORG
Same pattern on our side. He's not invading.
(beat)
He's rewriting.

Steve steps into the space between the two lines.

STEVE
We can argue about trust later. Right now, we stand together.

A long beat. Superman nods. He steps forward and clasps Steve's forearm.

The lines break. Avengers and Leaguers close into one ragged formation as we CRANE UP over them, the rain, the city, the fleet still circling above.

SEQUENCE 5 — THE FIRST GREAT COMBINED BATTLE

5.1 **EXT. NEW YORK - AERIAL - NIGHT** 5.1

High and wide over the harbor. Enemy carriers regroup above the water. Dropships pour Hollows toward the evacuation routes. A battlefield laid out like a map.

5.2 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 5.2

Steve stands on a wrecked truck, voice cutting through the noise.

STEVE
Stark, Lantern, take the sky. Diana, with me on the line.

As he speaks, the heroes move.

STEVE (CONT'D)
Hulk, Aquaman, the waterfront. Strange, Batman, find what's powering this. Flash, kid, get

those people out.

They peel away: fliers climbing, Hulk and Aquaman toward the water, Flash and Spider-Man toward the crowds.

5.3 **EXT. SKY - NIGHT** 5.3

Iron Man and Green Lantern fly wingtip to wingtip toward a wall of gunships.

GREEN LANTERN
Ever ride a ramp, Stark?

TONY
Is that a real question?

5.4 **EXT. BROOKLYN WATERFRONT - NIGHT** 5.4

The harbor BULGES. Water sheets off a black carapace as the LEVIATHAN rises: a war machine sixty meters tall, half crab, half cathedral. Its sonic cannon swings toward the apartment towers along the shore.

5.5 **EXT. MADISON AVENUE - NIGHT** 5.5

Steve and Wonder Woman stand at the head of a defensive line of police and firefighters. Behind them, civilians stream down the avenue toward the bridge. Ahead, a phalanx of Hollows advances behind energy shields.

5.6 **EXT. SKY - NIGHT** 5.6

Green Lantern throws out his fist and a RAMP of green light unrolls across the sky, a long curved half-pipe climbing toward the largest carrier. Iron Man hits it at full burn and ACCELERATES along it, the construct ringing under him.

He launches off the end, soars above the carrier, flips, and pours a concentrated barrage into the exposed engine bank.

5.7 **EXT. BROOKLYN WATERFRONT - NIGHT** 5.7

Hulk lands on the Leviathan's back and goes to work. Punch. A plate buckles. Punch. A seam splits. The machine staggers back into the harbor. He's winning.

5.8 **EXT. ROOFTOP - DIMENSIONAL FRONT - NIGHT** 5.8

Batman, Strange and Cyborg crouch beside a pillar of violet light rising from a crater toward the rupture. Batman projects a blue holographic model, built from scans of the wreckage.

CYBORG
Their tech's talking to something. Three somethings.

5.9 **EXT. SEVENTH AVENUE - NIGHT** 5.9

An awning sags under burning debris; people are trapped beneath it. THE FLASH becomes a red streak: one heartbeat, a zigzag of lightning, and every one of them is standing safely at the corridor barricade, blinking.

5.10 **EXT. HIGH-RISE - CONTINUOUS** 5.10

A window-washing platform snaps. Two workers fall. Spider-Man swings in, snags one, webs the other, and swings both onto a balcony.

SPIDER-MAN
Hi! Hey! You're okay. Don't look down.

5.11 **EXT. MADISON AVENUE - NIGHT** 5.11

Steve hurls his shield. It CRACKS off a Hollow's helmet, a second's shield, a third's chest, and comes back hot and fast. Wonder Woman meets it with her bracers in a flash of sparks and redirects it into the heart of the phalanx, scattering them like pins. It rebounds into Steve's hand.

They exchange a glance. It looks practiced. It isn't.

WONDER WOMAN
Again?

STEVE
Again.

5.12 **EXT. BROOKLYN WATERFRONT - NIGHT** 5.12

Hulk winds up and strikes. This time the Leviathan's armor RIPPLES and re-forms into layered violet scales. The punch rebounds in a shockwave that flings Hulk a hundred meters into the harbor.

5.13 **EXT. ROOFTOP - DIMENSIONAL FRONT - NIGHT** 5.13

Strange reaches into Batman's hologram. Orange geometry wraps the blue model, translating it, and three nodes light up deep inside it.

STRANGE
Three anchors. They're holding the machine in place.

5.14 **EXT. SKY - NIGHT** 5.14

The carrier's engines detonate in sequence. It lists and drops, away from the city, toward the open bay.

A troop transport tumbles burning toward a bridge. Superman catches it, spins, and HURLS it out over the open water, where it skips and sinks harmlessly.

5.15 **EXT. HARBOR - UNDERWATER - NIGHT** 5.15

Green-black water. AQUAMAN glides beneath the Leviathan's legs and sees it: a cooling intake below the waterline, glowing, unarmored. It has to stay open to breathe.

5.16 **EXT. BROOKLYN WATERFRONT - CONTINUOUS** 5.16

Hulk surfaces, spitting water, furious. Aquaman bursts up beside him.

AQUAMAN
Stop punching it! Take its legs!

Hulk grabs a foreleg, plants his feet in the riverbed and HEAVES. The Leviathan tilts.

Underwater, Aquaman drives his trident into the open intake. Lightning flashes through the water.

5.17 **EXT. ROOFTOP - DIMENSIONAL FRONT - NIGHT** 5.17

BATMAN
Then we break all three.

STRANGE
Not in the wrong order. Pull one too soon and the others tear free. It wouldn't stop the collapse. It would accelerate it.

CYBORG
So, timing.

BATMAN
Timing.

5.18 **EXT. SIXTH AVENUE - NIGHT** 5.18

Spider-Man swings in with a rescued child under one arm. The Flash is already standing at his web's anchor point, forty evacuees delivered behind him.

THE FLASH
Need a hand?

SPIDER-MAN
I have two! I'm using them!

5.19 **EXT. BROOKLYN BRIDGE APPROACH - EVACUATION CORRIDOR - NIGHT** 5.19

Black Panther holds the barricade alone against a fresh wave of Hollows. He takes the volley, glowing brighter with every hit, then unleashes the stored energy in a purple shockwave. The corridor holds. Civilians stream past him onto the bridge and down to the ferries.

5.20 **EXT. BROOKLYN WATERFRONT - NIGHT** 5.20

The Leviathan topples, slow and enormous, through the shell of an abandoned refinery. Brick, steel and dust roll across the waterfront in a wave.

5.21 **EXT. SEVENTH AVENUE - NIGHT** 5.21

The Flash pauses. Across the street a window pane falls, SHATTERS... and is back in its frame. It falls. Shatters. Back in its frame.

THE FLASH
That window's fallen three times.

5.22 **EXT. NEW YORK - AERIAL - NIGHT** 5.22

The carrier sinks into the bay. The Leviathan lies broken. The phalanx is scattered. The music swells. From every direction, heroes converge on the Crossing.

5.23 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 5.23

Superman, Thor, Wonder Woman and Iron Man drive the last of the Hollows back.

THOR
They break!

Superman draws back his fist for the final blow...

And the battlefield FREEZES.

Every explosion stops in midair, fireballs hanging like paper lanterns. Falling debris hangs motionless. Rain stands in the air as beads of glass. A burning car hangs upside down a meter off the ground.

Sound drops away to a single thin, high tone.

The heroes cannot move. Superman is frozen mid-punch. Spider-Man hangs mid-swing. Only their eyes can move.

Thanos walks into the frozen battlefield. Calm. Unhurried. The suspended rain parts around him. He passes within a meter of Superman's fist.

THANOS
(softly)
Thank you.

He raises the gauntlet and touches the Stones, one by one.

Reality begins to run BACKWARD.

SEQUENCE 6 — THANOS TURNS THE TIDE

6.1 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 6.1

A missile flies backward into Iron Man's shoulder launcher. A fireball shrinks into a spark. A collapsed building REBUILDS itself floor by floor, stands whole for one impossible second, then falls again.

Iron Man fires at Thanos. The beams BEND around him like light around a black hole.

6.2 **EXT. SEVENTH AVENUE - NIGHT** 6.2

The Flash runs at full speed. A newsstand flashes past. A falling newspaper. A red fire hydrant.

The newsstand flashes past. The falling newspaper. The red fire hydrant.

THE FLASH
No, no, no...

He skids to a stop on the same street corner, chest heaving.

THE FLASH (CONT'D)
It's a loop. The whole block's a loop.

6.3 **EXT. SIXTH AVENUE - CONTINUOUS** 6.3

Spider-Man clings to a lamppost. Ghost-echoes of every movement around him, things that already happened, flicker in his vision. His lenses go wide.

SPIDER-MAN
It's going off for everything. For stuff that already happened. I can't tell what's coming!

6.4 **EXT. THE CROSSING - CONTINUOUS** 6.4

Superman tears free and CHARGES Thanos at full speed.

Thanos doesn't look. He lifts the gauntlet, and a lens of rippling force bends Superman's path sideways, through the façade of a damaged building, which collapses on top of him.

Wonder Woman attacks. Sword high, sword low, shield bash. Thanos gives ground, blocking with forearm and gauntlet, sparks flying.

Then he catches her blade under the gauntlet, drives a knee into her shield and SHOVES. She skids thirty meters across the battlefield, boots carving trenches. She rises. She does not let go of the sword.

Above, Iron Man and Thor attack together.

TONY
Thor! Now!

Thor pours lightning into Iron Man's chest. Tony fires it as one blinding beam.

Thanos meets it with the open gauntlet. The beam pools INTO the Stones, which blaze brighter, and he answers with a shockwave that flings them both out of the sky.

In the rubble, Hulk pushes himself up on shaking arms, and falls.

6.5 **INT. IRON MAN HELMET - CONTINUOUS** 6.5

Tony's HUD overlays two graphs: every hero attack, and the energy output of the distant machine. Superman's charge: a spike. The lightning beam: a bigger spike. They match perfectly.

TONY
Every hit we land, that thing gets stronger.
(beat)
He wanted us swinging.

6.6 **EXT. THE CROSSING - BEHIND COVER - CONTINUOUS** 6.6

Batman crouches behind a wrecked car, studying his gauntlet's log: a grapple shot recorded as landing BEFORE it was fired.

BATMAN
His Stones aren't just bending space. He's editing what we see. Cause and effect, out of order.
(into comms)
Everyone stop attacking. Every strike is feeding it. Fall back!

6.7 **EXT. THE CROSSING - NIGHT** 6.7

High and wide. Thanos stands alone at the center of the devastation, heroes scattered in the rubble around him.

THANOS
The universe is not destroyed by its enemies.

He raises the gauntlet.

THANOS (CONT'D)
It is destroyed by the belief that it can remain unchanged.

The SKY FRACTURES. Geometric cracks race across the heavens from horizon to horizon; shards of sky fall away like glass, revealing violet void behind. The fleet opens fire on everything below: the streets, the river, the evacuation ferries crossing the harbor.

6.8 **EXT. NEW YORK HARBOR - CONTINUOUS** 6.8

Green Lantern hurls himself over the water and throws up a DOME of green light over the ferries, the corridor and the retreating heroes. The barrage hammers it. Every impact

drives him lower in the air. Sweat. Shaking arm.

LANTERN RING (V.O.)
Power level critical.

GREEN LANTERN
(through his teeth)
Not yet.

6.9 **EXT. THE CROSSING - CONTINUOUS** 6.9

Superman bursts out of the rubble, grabs Hulk and hauls him toward the dome.

The others fall back under the green light, all but one. Wonder Woman stands alone between Thanos and the retreating heroes, sword raised, until the last of them, Spider-Man carrying the paramedic, is past her.

Only then does she back into the dome. She never turns her back on him.

Strange rises at the dome's apex, mandalas wheeling around it, pressing back the fracturing sky. Blood runs from his nose.

6.10 **INT. GREEN LANTERN'S DOME - CONTINUOUS** 6.10

Beneath the green light, the alliance. Spider-Man shaking. The Flash on his knees. Thor bleeding from the scalp. Superman dusted grey with concrete.

For the first time, every one of them understands that they could lose.

Outside, Thanos watches them through the green light. Then he turns away, unhurried, and walks into the smoke.

SEQUENCE 7 — THE PLAN

7.1 **INT. STARK EMERGENCY OPERATIONS BUNKER - SUBLEVEL 9 - NIGHT** 7.1

Emergency lights. Water drips from a cracked ceiling. Half the screens are dead.

The heroes regroup. Tony sits with his helmet off, armor scorched black down one side. Superman's cape hangs torn. Diana's shield is dented. The Flash sits against the wall, legs trembling. Hulk sits on the floor in a drift of concrete dust. Spider-Man's mask is pushed up to his nose.

STRANGE
He let us walk away.

BATMAN
He doesn't need to beat us. He needs us to keep fighting the wrong way.

Batman throws a hologram into the middle of the room: the ETERNITY ENGINE. Three rings around a sphere. Three points glow on it: CROWN at the top, ROOT at the base, HEART at the core.

TONY
Three anchors. Crown, Root, Heart. They have to go dark inside the same window, and I mean narrow. Under half a second.

STRANGE
And in order. Crown and Root together, then the Heart, in the same heartbeat. Out of sequence, the fold collapses onto Earth.

CYBORG
The anchors sync to a carrier pulse. I can ride it and open a gap in the Heart's shield, but somebody has to be standing there when it opens.

THE FLASH
(quietly)
Half a second's a long time.

BATMAN
He reads everything we react to. So we don't react. We run this on a clock. Ours, not his.

STRANGE
I can bind every one of you to a single count. Whatever he shows you, trust the count.

Steve steps up to the hologram. Three team icons light around the Engine as he speaks.

STEVE
Team one, air. Stark, Thor, Superman, Lantern. Pull the fleet off and expose the Crown.
(turns)

Team two, ground. Diana, Hulk, Aquaman, T'Challa, me. We take the Root gate and hold it.
(turns)
Team three. Batman, Strange, Cyborg, Flash, Parker. You're the Heart.

SPIDER-MAN
Why do I feel like that's the worst one?

BATMAN
Because it is.

WONDER WOMAN
And if one team fails...

STEVE
None of us finish. So nobody fails.

He looks at them: the bruised, the burned, the exhausted. People who were strangers an hour ago.

STEVE (CONT'D)
We don't have to win every fight.

He glances at the hologram, at the Heart, turning slowly.

STEVE (CONT'D)
We just have to make this one count.

A low string motif begins. One by one, they stand. Hulk is last. He pushes himself up off the floor and rises to his full height.

Strange draws a circle in the air. A portal burns open onto a vast violet distance.

They walk into it.

SEQUENCE 8 — THE WAR FOR REALITY

8.1 **EXT. THE ETERNITY ENGINE - ABOVE THE SHATTERED WORLD OF ORUN** 8.1

Scale beyond comprehension.

A dead world broken into continents of floating rock. Above it hangs the ETERNITY ENGINE: three colossal metallic rings, each a thousand kilometers of machined alloy, turning slowly around a central sphere of violet fire. Starlight bends around the structure. Lightning runs along invisible

geometric pathways through the void.

On a drifting rock, tiny against all of it, Strange's portal opens and the heroes step through. The Engine's field holds a thin, cold atmosphere. Their breath steams.

Deep in the violet sphere, on a dais at the mouth of the Heart, a vast figure turns: Thanos. Around the structure, the fleet wheels toward them.

STEVE
On the count.

Strange spreads his fingers. A thin orange RING lights around every hero's wrist. It pulses, once, like a heartbeat.

BATMAN
Clock starts now.

A soft, steady TICK enters the soundtrack. It will not stop.

8.2 **EXT. THE RINGS - CONTINUOUS** 8.2

Iron Man threads the gaps between the rotating rings at full burn, beams scything past him.

A gunship locks onto him. A line of heat vision cuts its cannon off at the root: Superman, banking past.

Thor rises above the structure and raises Stormbreaker. A STORM ignites across the void, lightning lacing every ring and lighting the entire Engine like a cathedral at night. Silhouetted in the flashes: hundreds of enemy ships.

8.3 **EXT. DIMENSIONAL GAP - CONTINUOUS** 8.3

A crack in space yawns wider between two floating fragments. Green Lantern throws a BRIDGE across it. Team Two charges onto the bridge.

Above them, a ring segment sheared off by Thor's storm tumbles down toward the bridge. Superman catches it, straining against its mass, and heaves it aside into the void.

8.4 **EXT. THE CROWN - CONTINUOUS** 8.4

Iron Man's repulsors splash off a gunship's hull; its mirrored skin throws the blast straight back at him.

TONY

They're learning.

THOR
Then we teach faster.

Tony switches to kinetic rounds. Thor follows them in. The gunship screen around the summit crumbles, and the CROWN stands exposed: a crystal spire on the highest ring, pulsing violet.

TONY
Crown's exposed!

8.5 **EXT. THE ROOT GATE - CONTINUOUS** 8.5

At the base of the Engine, where it is moored to the dead world, stands a GATE of black armor two hundred meters high. Before it, the ASCENDANT GUARD: Thanos's elite, three meters tall, glaives crackling.

Steve and Diana meet them together. Diana's lasso snaps around a glaive and yanks; Steve's shield breaks the guard's stance; Diana's sword finishes it. They move to the next without a word.

Hulk reaches the gate, sinks his fingers into the seam and PULLS. Metal shrieks. The gate splits.

The Guard's cannons open up on the breach. Black Panther steps into the fire and drinks it in, then throws it back as a purple shockwave that clears the gateway.

Aquaman leads the charge through, trident spinning. Beyond the gate rises the ROOT: a pillar of glowing crystal as thick as a skyscraper, sunk into the dead world like a tooth.

STEVE
Root's ours!

8.6 **INT. THE ENGINE - MECHANICAL PASSAGE** 8.6

A narrow passage through the machine. Gear-rings the size of houses grind past each other, closing the way.

Spider-Man fires lines onto a spinning ring and anchors them to a strut. The webs stretch, smoke, and hold. The ring slows. Batman slips through the gap.

SPIDER-MAN
Okay. Not trusting the tingle.
Trusting the count.

BATMAN
There. That's the way into the Heart.

8.7 **INT. THE ENGINE - COLLAPSING CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS** 8.7

The Flash runs a corridor that is coming apart in time: sections of floor repeat, hang, jump forward. He zigzags between the fragments, his lightning tracing a clean route through the chaos.

Strange opens portals ahead of him to keep the team connected. Each one flickers more than the last, its edges fraying.

STRANGE
The portals won't hold much longer.

Cyborg plugs his arm into a control node. Code floods his eye.

CYBORG
I've got the carrier pulse. Crown and Root on the zero. Heart in the same beat.

8.8 **INT. THE HEART - CONTINUOUS** 8.8

A spherical chamber so vast that clouds form inside it. At its center, the HEART: a core of white light inside a dense shell of churning purple energy.

On the dais at the chamber's mouth, Thanos turns toward the control platform.

Superman and Wonder Woman drop in front of him.

THANOS
You cannot stop what has already begun.

SUPERMAN
Watch us.

They engage. Every time Thanos turns toward the platform, one of them is in his way.

Green Lantern braces the shaking chamber with girders of green light.

Strange holds open a portal ring connecting the Heart to the Crown.

At the Crown, Iron Man and Thor hover over the conduits, charged.

TONY
Conduits at a hundred and ten percent.

At the Heart's shell, the Flash crouches. Lightning gathers around him. The orange ring on his wrist pulses.

THE FLASH
(under his breath)
Three. Two.

BATMAN
Now.

Thor and Iron Man overload the conduits: lightning and repulsor fire pour into the Crown.

In the same instant, the Flash moves. EXTREME SLOW MOTION: the purple shell flickers open for a fraction of a heartbeat, and his hand goes through the gap and strikes the core.

Silence.

For a moment, the entire universe seems to stop breathing. Drifting particles hang in the air. Faces, waiting.

Then the CROWN goes dark.

The ROOT follows; its light drains down into the dead world.

The HEART shudders, and its shell begins to COLLAPSE inward, layer by layer.

CLOSE ON THANOS

For the first time, his composure breaks.

THANOS
No.

He tears free of Superman and Wonder Woman and launches himself across the chamber toward the central control platform, a violet meteor.

SEQUENCE 9 — SUPERMAN, THOR, AND WONDER WOMAN VS. THANOS

9.1 **EXT. THE CAUSEWAY - CONTROL PLATFORM - CONTINUOUS** 9.1

Thanos lands on the floating causeway that leads to the control platform. The surrounding structure BREAKS APART

under the impact; fragments drift upward in the low gravity.

Superman, Thor and Wonder Woman land in a line between him and the platform. Behind them, Batman, Cyborg and the Flash work the controls while the Heart collapses beyond.

THANOS
Every war you have fought began as someone's choice. I am ending choice.

WONDER WOMAN
Then you are ending everything worth fighting for.

Superman goes first. Jab, cross, hook: controlled and fast. Thanos blocks one, two, three on his forearms, giving ground.

Superman's eyes ignite. Heat vision at point-blank range. Thanos turns the gauntlet into it, and the beam SPLITS into harmless sparks across the stones.

Thanos hammers the gauntlet into Superman's chest. Superman flies backward, THROUGH a floating rock formation, which bursts into gravel behind him.

Thor plummets from above, lightning wrapping Stormbreaker. At the top of his fall he hangs for a heartbeat, gathering it all. He strikes. Thanos takes it on the raised gauntlet, and a burst of energy erupts toward the control platform.

Wonder Woman slides in sideways, angles her shield and DEFLECTS the burst away from the platform, out into the void.

Thor high, Diana low. They press Thanos back step by step. Diana's lasso snaps around his gauntlet arm and pulls it wide; Thor drives Stormbreaker into the exposed chest plate. The armor CRACKS.

Thanos wrenches the lasso, yanking Diana off her feet, and hurls her into Thor.

Superman returns from the rubble and TACKLES Thanos. They lock together, shoving, the causeway breaking under their feet. Superman's face strains. Thanos's calm slips into effort.

But slowly, Thanos takes over.

He catches Thor's weapon arm mid-swing, twists, and rips Stormbreaker away, flinging it spinning out into the void. Thor drops to one knee.

Wonder Woman attacks. A gauntlet blow drives her back behind her shield; a backhand cracks across her raised bracers. She

goes down.

Superman charges. Thanos catches him by the throat and drives him down into the causeway, which craters around him.

BATMAN (V.O.)
(over comms)
Cascade at sixty percent. Keep him off the platform.

Low, at ground level. Three heroes in the dust, struggling to rise. Fragments of stone drift upward around them.

Thanos walks toward them, unhurried.

THANOS
You mistake resistance for victory.

Superman lifts his head. His eyes go past Thanos to the distant Heart, collapsing.

SUPERMAN
No.

He pushes himself upright. His cape is torn half away.

SUPERMAN (CONT'D)
We're buying time.

Thor rises beside him. He holds out his hand. Far out in the void, Stormbreaker turns, and comes home to his palm with a crack of thunder.

Wonder Woman stands, sword raised.

Behind Thanos, deep in the frame, the shutdown sequence reaches its final stage: the Heart's shell crumpling inward, Batman and Cyborg at the controls.

SEQUENCE 10 — THE FINAL GAMBIT

10.1 **EXT. CONTROL PLATFORM - CONTINUOUS** 10.1

Iron Man drops onto the platform beside Batman. On the console, the collapse STALLS. The Heart's shell begins to re-form.

CYBORG
He's feeding it from the Stones.
It's holding!

STRANGE

The Stones are fused into the loop. Tear them out and the loop takes Earth with them.

BATMAN
Then we make him choose. Every control point at once. He can hold the Engine or he can fight us. Not both.

TONY
And somebody has to be at the core to finish it.
(beat)
I'll take the core.

Batman looks at him.

BATMAN
Stark.

TONY
I know.

10.2 **EXT. THE HEART - CONTINUOUS** 10.2

The Flash runs a circle around the collapsing Heart, a ring of red lightning. Control points light one after another in his wake.

A support strut cracks and the mechanism begins to tear apart. Spider-Man fires line after line onto anchor points, braces his feet, and HOLDS it together.

SPIDER-MAN
Hold... hold... hold!

Strange keeps the dimensional seal, mandalas locked around the Heart, his hands trembling.

The discharge from the Heart lashes outward. Green Lantern throws a dome over the others.

LANTERN RING (V.O.)
Power level three percent.

Iron Man flies straight at the central energy column. Shield segments unfold around him, layer upon layer of nanotech, energy streaming off them like water off glass.

Thanos sees the column flicker. Light is pouring OUT of the gauntlet into the Engine. He's losing it.

He abandons the Engine and launches himself at Tony.

Superman intercepts him in midair. The collision rings out across the void.

Wonder Woman follows through with a shield strike that drives Thanos away from the platform.

Thor raises Stormbreaker and unleashes everything the storm has left. A column of lightning drives Thanos down onto the causeway.

Captain America sprints up the causeway from the Root, sees the last control point exposed, and THROWS.

The shield arcs past Thanos and strikes the final control point. The node shatters.

The Eternity Engine begins to COLLAPSE INWARD. The rings fold toward the sphere.

Thanos ROARS as the purple energy around him turns unstable, arcing wildly from the gauntlet.

The world changes. Color drains away. Sound DISAPPEARS. The rings stretch into impossible geometric shapes. Beyond them, the stars fold inward.

STRANGE
Everyone, move!

Portals burn open. The heroes dive through them: Steve, Diana, Hulk, Spider-Man, Thor.

10.3 **INT. IRON MAN HELMET - CONTINUOUS** 10.3

Tony at the heart of the column. The HUD reads: RELEASE - MANUAL ONLY.

At the edge of the last portal, Superman reaches back for him.

SUPERMAN
Tony!

Tony looks at the failing Engine.

Then at the heroes waiting beyond the portal: Steve, Superman, Strange holding the ring open with shaking hands.

TONY
Go.

He triggers the final release.

A colossal WAVE of white and violet energy engulfs the structure.

CUT TO BLACK.

Absolute silence.

SEQUENCE 11 — THE AFTERMATH

11.1 **EXT. THE SHATTERED WORLD - ENGINE WRECKAGE - LATER** 11.1

Silence. Slowly, light returns.

Twisted ring fragments lie across a field of dead stone. Glowing dust settles like snow.

Steve's eyes open.

Overhead, the Eternity Engine is gone. The fractures in the sky have closed. In the black, framed by the last thin seam of the closing rift, hangs EARTH: small, blue, wrapped in a faint glow of atmosphere.

The heroes gather. Some are injured. Some just sit. The Flash lies on his back, staring up. Green Lantern's ring is dark. Hulk sits with his arms on his knees.

We drift slowly from face to face.

Thor looks into the distant sky.

Steve pulls his shield from the debris.

Diana helps the Flash to his feet.

Batman kneels by a fractured piece of the machine and studies it.

BATMAN
No sign of him.

STRANGE
The Engine's gone. Every fracture is sealed. It's over.

Superman walks to a smoking, crumpled shell of nanotech armor. He grips its edges and pulls it open.

Inside, Tony Stark coughs, blinks, alive.

TONY
Did it work?

SUPERMAN
It worked.

TONY
Good. Because I'm not doing that again.

Superman helps him up.

The heroes stand together on the edge of the wreckage as Earth turns slowly in the distance.

SUPERMAN
Different worlds. Different lives.

STEVE
Same responsibility.

The theme rises. We PULL BACK, away from the heroes, the wreckage, the shattered world, into the vastness of space.

11.2 **EXTREME CLOSE ON A FRAGMENT OF THE MACHINE** 11.2

Deep inside a crack in the metal, a tiny PURPLE SPARK flickers.

Once.

CUT TO BLACK.

INFINITY CRISIS

THE WAR IS NOT OVER.

END